Bluebook Training, Rules 15-17

Monday, March 2, 2026

Admissions Updates

- Admissions Statement is released – due **March 9, 5:00 PM**
- **Online *Bluebook* access** – **email Mahek** ASAP
- **Office Hours**:

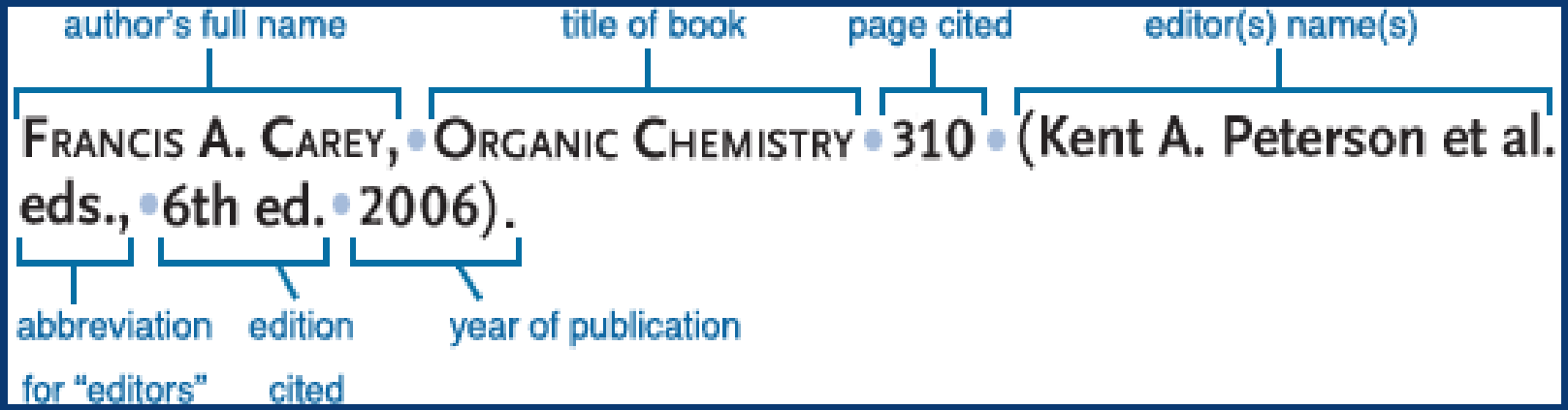
Mon., Mar. 2, 2-3 p.m.	DE Office Hours	SLB Dining Hall
Tue., Mar. 10, 2-3 p.m.	DE Office Hours	SLB Dining Hall
Fri., Mar. 27, 2-4 p.m.	EDE & EDME & DE Office Hours[3]	SLB Dining Hall
Tue., Mar. 31, 1-2 p.m.	EDE & EDME Office Hours	SLB Dining Hall

Overview

- Rule 15: Books, Reports & Other Nonperiodic Materials
- Rule 16: Periodical Materials
- Rule 17: Unpublished and Forthcoming Sources

Rule 15: Books, Reports & Other Nonperiodic Materials

Books & Nonperiodic Materials



- SMALL CAPS for author and title
- An even simpler example:
  - MICHELLE OBAMA, BECOMING 22 (2018)

Author

- Give the author's full name as it appears in the source.
  - Example: WILLIAM A. GIBSON, JR.
  - Do not include any professional designations (Dr., Prof., etc.)

S.R. 15.1(b): Et al.

Author

- When a source is cited for the first time, if there are five or less authors, list all, and use an ampersand. If there are six or more authors, use "et al."
  - Example: ADAM B. COX & CRISTINA M. RODRÍGUEZ
  - List in the order they appear on the source
- When a source is cited in its short form, use et al. if there are three or more authors in the original source
  - Original Source: [1] Cristina Isabel Ceballos, David Freeman Engstrom & Daniel E. Ho, *Disparate Limbo: How Administrative Law Erased Antidiscrimination*, 131 YALE L.J. 370 (2021).
    - Correct: [6] Ceballos et al., *supra* note 1, at 380.
    - Incorrect: [6] ~~Ceballos, Engstrom & Ho, *supra* note 1, at 380.~~
  - Original Source: [1] Jacob Goldin & Ariel Jurow Kleiman, *Whose Child Is This? Improving Child-Claiming Rules in Safety-Net Programs*, 131 YALE L.J. 1720 (2021).
    - Correct: [6] Goldin & Kleiman, *supra* note 1, at 1730.
    - Incorrect: [6] ~~Goldin et al., *supra* note 1, at 1730.~~

Institutional Authors

- Sometimes, the author is not a person, but an institution.
  - City of New Haven, Recycle Now New Haven (1991).
- Abbreviate the institutional author according to **T6** and **T10**.
- You can also credit a person writing on behalf of an institution.
  - Judith A. Lhamon, Nat'l Ass'n for L. Placement, A Fair Shake: Lawful and Effective Interviewing 3 (1987).
- When no individual author is credited, use the smallest subdivision that prepared the work

Editor or Translators

- If the book has an editor or translator, put that information in the date parenthetical.
- Format: ([Full name] ed., [Full name] trans., [year])
  - Use the name as it appears (follow Rule 15.1)
  - NO comma before "ed." or "trans."
  - Example: (Joseph Katz ed., Samuel Moore trans., 2008).
- Use "eds." if there is more than one editor.
  - AIDS AND THE LAW (Harlon L. Dalton & Scott Burris eds., 1987).

Title

- Cite full title as it appears on the title page.
  - But capitalize according to Rule 8, not the source.
- Do not abbreviate or omit articles.
- S.R.15.3: Contrary to *The Bluebook*, default is to include the subtitle (but only the first).
- If the title ends with a number, set off the title from any pincite using “, at”
  - JOSEPH HELLER, CATCH-22, at 4 (1961).

Edition, Publisher, Date

- Include date even if the date is in the title of the document.
- Single-edition work: just give the year of publication
  - TRUMAN CAPOTE, IN COLD BLOOD (1965).
- Multiple editions, same publisher: give the edition + year.
  - WAYNE R. LAFAVE, CRIMINAL LAW (5th ed. 2010).
  - Note: NO comma after "ed." for editions, but YES comma after "ed." for editors!
- Different publisher from original edition: give the publisher + edition cited + original date of publication
  - CHARLES DICKENS, BLEAK HOUSE (Norman Page ed., Penguin Books 1971) (1853).

Rule 15.4

- Cite pre-1900 works to a modern, scholarly edition.
  - JOHN LOCKE, TWO TREATISES OF GOVERNMENT (Peter Laslett ed., Cambridge Univ. Press 1988) (1690).
  - S.R. 15.4(d): When citing an original edition of a pre-1900 work, abbreviate all places of publication— including cities, not just states and countries per 15.4(d)—according to T10.
  - If no post-1900 edition, cite to first edition with location and publisher information.
    - 1 JAMES FITZJAMES STEPHEN, A HISTORY OF THE CRIMINAL LAW OF ENGLAND (London, MacMillan & Co. 1883).

Shorter Works in Collection

- For an individual piece in a collection of works by various authors, you'll use *in* (in italics) after the author and title of the piece.
  - Jameka Williams, *Thoughts on a Birthday Party*, *in* MISREPRESENTED PEOPLE: POETIC RESPONSES TO TRUMP'S AMERICA 55, 70 (María Isabel Alvarez & Dante Di Stefano eds., 2018).
- For a collection of works all by the same author, use the same format, but the author's name goes in small caps.
  - STEPHEN KING, *The Jaunt*, *in* SKELETON CREW 15, 16 (1985).
- Always note the page on which the shorter work begins!
- For collected materials that were previously published, use "*reprinted in*"
  - MARQUIS DE CONDORCET, ESSAY ON THE APPLICATION OF MATHEMATICS TO THE THEORY OF DECISION-MAKING (1785), *reprinted in* CONDORCET: SELECTED WRITINGS 33, 48–49 (Keith M. Baker ed., 1976).

Prefaces, Introductions, etc.

- Only note this if it is written by a different author.
  - L. Maria Child, *Introduction* to HARRIET A. JACOBS, INCIDENTS IN THE LIFE OF A SLAVE GIRL 3, 3-4 (L. Maria Child & Jean F. Yellin eds., Harvard Univ. Press 1987) (1861).

- Otherwise, no special designation.
  - JOHN HART ELY, DEMOCRACY AND DISTRUST, at vii (1980).
    - We use a comma before the "at" here because this pincite contains letters instead of digits

Special Citation Forms

- There are special citation forms for a couple of frequently cited works.
- Be familiar with what can be found here, then just follow the templates.
- Special sources include:
  - Am. Jur. (American Jurisprudence)
  - Wright and Miller's Federal Practice and Procedure
  - The Bible
  - Shakespeare
  - *The Bluebook*!

Rule 15.8

- The Federalist is one of the most common special forms.
- Make sure the author's name is included parenthetically.
  - THE FEDERALIST NO. 23 (Alexander Hamilton).
- When pinciting a Federalist paper, include publication information for the edition cited.
  - THE FEDERALIST NO. 5, at 53 (John Jay) (Clinton Rossiter ed., 1961).

S.R. 15.8(a)

- Cite dictionary entries according to the following example:
  - *See Vehicle*, WEBSTER'S NEW INTERNATIONAL DICTIONARY (3d ed. 1934).

- When citing an online dictionary, append the URL to the citation.

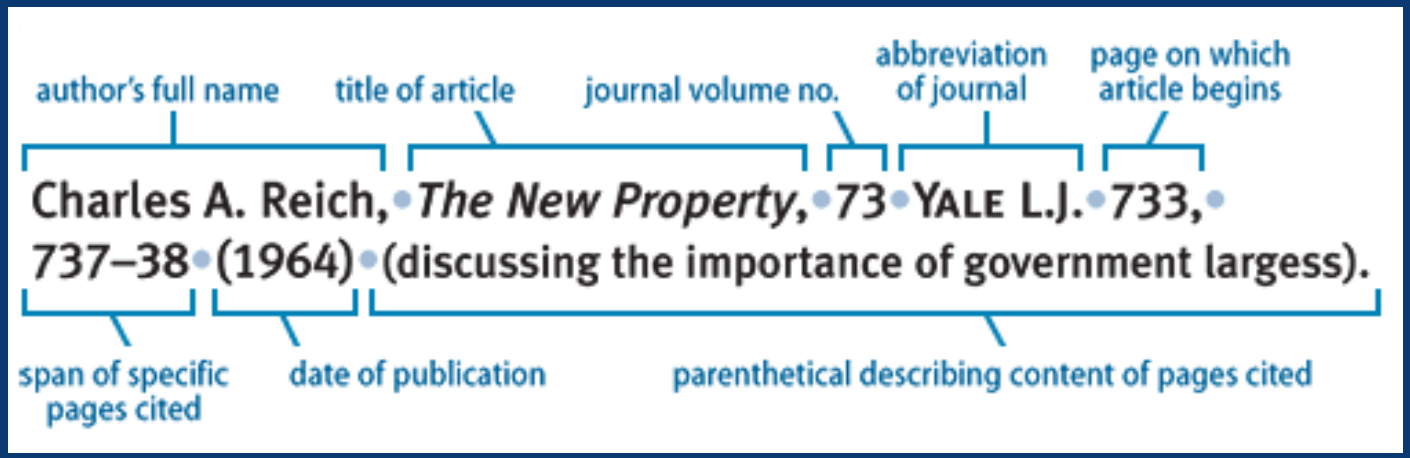
Short Form

- Once a source has been cited in full, you can use *id.* or *supra*.
- MAKE SURE YOUR TYPEFACE IS RIGHT!
  - WOODWARD, *supra* note 5, at 93.
- *Supra* can be used to refer to either a shorter work in a collection or to the collection as a whole (if you are citing to a new piece of the same larger work).
  - Example of the latter: *But see* STEPHEN KING, *Survivor Type*, *in* SKELETON CREW, *supra* note 3, at 152.

Rule 16: Periodical Materials

Rule 16

Periodical Materials



Authors & Titles

Author

- Follow Rule 15.1 and Style Guide Rules
- Romanized

Title

- *Italicized*
  - But: romanize anything that would be italicized in main text
  - Example: *Understanding* Roe*: Abortion Rights After 1973*
- Capitalize according to Rule 8
- Do not abbreviate or omit articles in the title

Consecutively Paginated Journals

- This means that the periodical doesn't restart at page 1 for each issue (like *YLJ*)

VOLUME	133	2023-2024	
NUMBER	4	FEBRUARY 2024	1039-1400
NUMBER	3	JANUARY 2024	669-1038
NUMBER	2	NOVEMBER 2023	419-668
NUMBER	1	OCTOBER 2023	1-418

Rule 16.4

- Format: [Author], [*Title*], [Vol. #] [PERIODICAL NAME] [first page], pincite (year).

- Abbreviate the periodical name: T10, T6 and T13.
  - David Rudovsky, *Police Abuse: Can the Violence Be Contained?*, 27 HARV. C.R.-C.L. L. REV. 465, 500 (1992).
    - T6: Civil Rights → C.R.; Civil Liberty → C.L.

- Some periodicals have no volume numbers → use the year of publication instead, and omit the date parenthetical.
  - Thomas R. McCoy, *Conditional Spending: Federalism's Trojan Horse*, 1988 SUP. CT. REV. 85, 86.

Nonconsecutively Paginated Periodicals

- This means that the periodical does restart at page 1 for each issue.
- Format: [Author], [*Title*], [PERIODICAL NAME], [date of issue], at [first page], [pincite].
  - Cite the date of issue as it appears on the cover; abbreviate months according to T12.
  - Abbreviate the periodical according to T6, T10, and T13.
  - Aaron Roper, *Explaining Hurricanes*, TIME, Feb. 28, 2017, at 69, 71.

Nonconsecutively Paginated Periodicals

- Some journals restart pagination for every *article* within an issue.
  - Replace the first page with "art no. X"
  - Wim Carton, Adeniyi Asiyanbi, Silke Beck, Holly J. Buck & Jens F. Lund, *Negative Emissions and the Long History of Carbon Removal*, 11 WIRES CLIMATE CHANGE art. no. e671, at 15 (2020)

Newspapers

- Cite print newspapers in the same way as nonconsecutively paginated periodicals, with a few exceptions:
  - When appropriate, designate the work as an "Editorial," "Opinion," or "Letter to the Editor," in ordinary roman type, after the author's name but before the title. Also include these designations for online newspapers.
  - Include the place of publication in parentheses if unclear from the title.
    - Nancy Reagan, Editorial, *Just Say "Woah,"* WALL ST. J., Jan. 23, 1996, at A14.
  - S.R. 16.6: Cite to first page of article and pincite like other print sources

S.R.16.6

- S.R. 16.6: *YLJ* prefers citations to online newspapers
  - John Markoff, *Computer Wins on "Jeopardy!": Trivial, It's Not*, N.Y. TIMES (Feb. 16, 2011), https://www.nytimes.com/2011/02/17/science/17jeopardy-watson.html [https://perma.cc/XYZ].
- S.R. 16.6(d): Online newspapers and wire services (Reuters, AP) use parentheses for dates. Append URL.
  - Kelly Wiese, Associated Press, *Once a Speed Trap, Town Is Counting Down*, L.A. TIMES (Jan. 16, 2005), https://articles.latimes.com/2005/jan/16/news/adna-macks16 [https://perma.cc/XYZ].

Special Forms

Have some idea of what can be found here:

- 16.7.1: Student-Written Law Review Materials
- 16.7.2: Non-Student-Written Book Reviews
- 16.7.3: Symposia, Colloquia, and Surveys
- 16.7.4: Commentaries and Other Special Designations
- 16.7.5: Multipart Articles
- 16.7.6: Annotations
- 16.7.7: Proceedings, Regular Publications by Institutes, and ABA Section Reports
- 16.7.8: Newsletters and Other Noncommercially Distributed Periodicals

Rule 16.7

- Yumehiko Hoshijima, Note, *Presidential Administration and the Durability of Climate-Consciousness*, 127 YALE L.J. 170, 171 (2017).
- James Durling, Comment, *The Intercircuit Exclusionary Rule*, 128 YALE L.J. 231, 240 (2018).
- Rebecca Goldstein, *The Politics of Decarceration*, 129 YALE L.J. 446, 482 (2019) (reviewing RACHEL ELISE BARKOW, PRISONERS OF POLITICS: BREAKING THE CYCLE OF MASS INCARCERATION (2019)).
- Symposium, *Changing Images of the State*, 107 HARV. L. REV. 1179, 1180-1201 (1994).

Explanatory Parentheticals

- Reminder: S.R. 1.5(b). Explanatory parentheticals go after the complete citation, including "*reprinted in*."
  - Louis Loss, *The Conflict of Laws and the Blue Sky Laws*,71 HARV. L. REV. 209 (1957), *reprinted in* LOUIS LOSS & EDWARD M. COWETT, BLUE SKY LAW 180 (1958) (discussing the bewildering array of state laws then governing interstate securities transactions).

Short Citation Forms

- *Id.* and *supra*!
- Use the first author's last name, *supra* note *X*, at *Y*
  - [1] Note, *Constitutional Constraints on Free Exercise Analogies*, 134 HARV. L. REV. 1782 (2021); Meenakshi Krishnan, *The Foreign Intelligence Surveillance Court and the Petition Clause: Rethinking the First Amendment Right of Access*, 130 YALE L.J. FORUM 723 (2021).
  - [2] Note, *supra* note 1, at 1787.
  - [3] Krishnan, *supra* note 1, at 729.
  - [4] *Id.;* Note, *supra* note 1.

Short Forms (A Recap)

Five-Footnote Rule	*Supra* (no five-footnote rule)	No non-*id.* short forms
• Cases • Legislative materials (minus hearings which use *hereinafter*) • Federal Register • Session laws	• Books • Periodicals • Internet sources • Unpublished sources • Archival sources	• Constitutions • U.S.C. • State codes • C.F.R.

Rule 17: Unpublished and Forthcoming Sources

Unpublished & Forthcoming Sources

- 17.2 Unpublished Materials—everything is romanized!
  - Manuscripts
  - Dissertations/Theses
  - Letters, Memoranda, Press Releases
  - Emails
  - Interviews
  - Speeches/Address
- 17.3 Forthcoming Sources
- 17.4 Working Papers

Manuscripts

- Format: [Author], [Title] [pincite] ([full date]) (unpublished manuscript) (on file with *X*).
  - Everything is romanized!
  - Example: Anatoli Bizhko, Capitalism and Democracy 25 (Feb. 29, 2000) (unpublished manuscript) (on file with author).
- S.R. 17: *YLJ* does not store manuscripts; do not cite manuscripts as being "on file with the Yale Law Journal."
  - Instead, either provide the public location of the manuscript or say "on file with author."

Dissertations/Thesis

- Cite unpublished student-written materials, like dissertations and theses, in the same way as manuscripts, but with an altered parenthetical:
  - Barbara G. Ryder, Incremental Data Flow Analysis Based on a Unified Model of Elimination Algorithms (Aug. 15, 1982) (Ph.D. dissertation, Rutgers University) (on file with author).

Letters, Memos, Press Releases

- Letters and Memos: need to identify the name, title, and institutional affiliation of both the writer and the addressee.
- FROM goes before TO
  - Letter from Michael Qin, Exec. Editor, Harvard L. Rev., to Alexandra Zabierek, Exec. Ed., Harv. L. Rev. (Oct. 1, 2014) (on file with the Harvard Law School Library).
- Abbreviate titles and institutional affiliations, T6 and T11
- Press Releases: include the title of the press release.
  - Press Release, Screen Actors Guild, Screen Actors Guild Hails Passage of California Privacy Law (Sep. 30, 1998) (on file with author).

Emails

- Analogize to unpublished letters (Rule 17.2.3).
- Include both a date and time stamp. Email address is not required.
- S.R. 22.15: We don't hyphenate "email," even though *The Bluebook* does.
  - Email from Mary Miles Prince, Assoc. Dir., Vanderbilt L. Libr., to Edward Brewer, III, Assistant Professor of L., Salmon P. Chase Coll. of L. (Sept. 26, 1999, 6:15 AM) (on file with author).

Interviews

- "Interview with" for in-person and "Telephone Interview with" for telephone.
- Abbreviate the title, institutional affiliation, and location of interview using T6 and T10.
  - No need to include a location if the interview is over the phone.
  - Telephone Interview with Sharon K. Robertson, Partner, Cohen, Milsten, Sellers & Toll (Jan. 11, 2021)
- If author has not personally conducted the interview, provide the name of the interviewer.
  - Interview by Lauren Brook Eisen with Shane Spradlin, CEO, Nextel Commc'ns, in Potomac, Md. (Mar. 1, 2000)

Speeches & Addresses

- (1) Speaker name
- (2) Speaker title and institutional affiliation, if included in the description/transcript or helpful to the reader
  - Abbreviate according to T6 and T10.
- (3) Title of the speech
  - If the speech has no formal title, provide a description with identifying information.
- (4) Full date of the speech
  - Bradley Smith, Chairman, Fed. Election Comm'n, Keynote Address at the University of Pennsylvania Law Review Symposium: The Law of Democracy (Feb. 6, 2004)

Forthcoming Publications

- Same as the published version (with the <u>same typefaces</u>!), except:
  - If a journal article, don't include the first page of the piece.
  - Add "forthcoming" in the date parenthetical.
  - Include month of publication, in addition to year, if available.
    - Sarah Greenberger, Comment, *Enforceable Rights, No Child Left Behind, and Political Patriotism*, 153 U. PA. L. REV. (forthcoming May 2022).
    - SARAH BARRINGER GORDON, THE TWIN RELICS OF BARBARISM (forthcoming 2001).
- Check for **logical errors** here. Is the date in the past?

If so, drop an LE query!

Rule 17.3

- Remember: If you are trying to pincite a forthcoming publication, you cite to the manuscript page in a parenthetical.
  - F. Brandon Baer & James M. Feldman, *We're Low on Vermouth: The Trials and Tribulations of Two Summer Associates*, 1 J.L. & OTHER THINGS (forthcoming May 2001) (manuscript at 3) (on file with authors).
- Include this in short forms too:
  - *Id.* (manuscript at 5).
- S.R. 17.3: If an unpublished work is a working paper but is scheduled for publication, cite under this rule, not 17.4.

Working Papers

- *Italicize* the title!
- Provide a parenthetical: the sponsoring organization, working paper number, and the year. Abbreviate according to T6 and T10.
  - Alan J. Auerbach & Laurence J. Kotlikoff, *National Savings, Economic Welfare, and the Structure of Taxation* 24-33 (Nat'l Bureau of Econ. Rsch., Working Paper No. 729, 1981), https://papers.ssrn.com/abstract=1652301 [https://perma.cc/XYZ].
- Rule 17.6, Short Citation Forms: *id.* and *supra*

Questions?

- Next training: Rules 18 - 21 on **Wednesday, Mar. 4 at 12:10 PM in SLB 128**